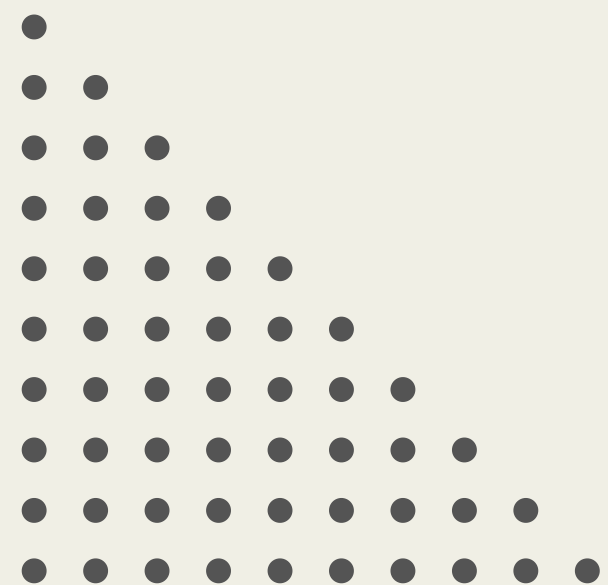
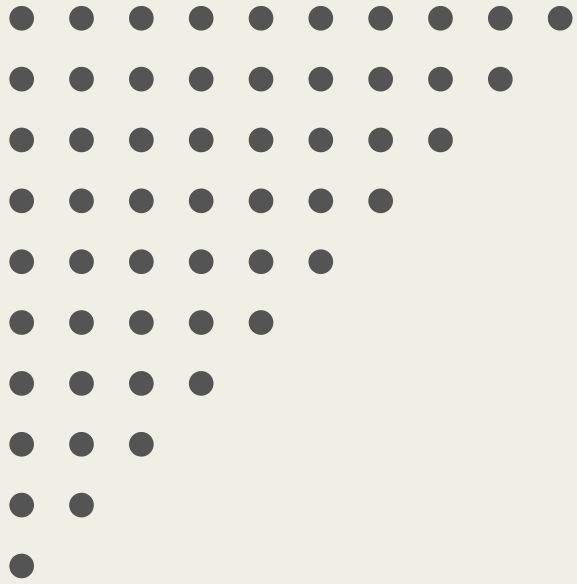




THE YEAR OF THE ELEPHANT

By Duaa Jahangir



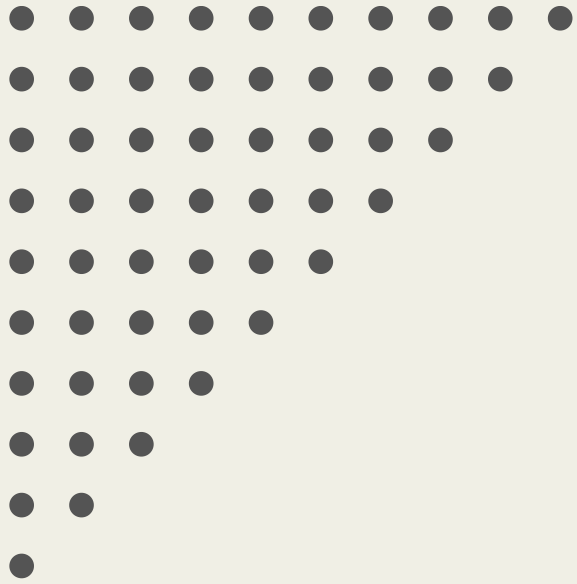


WHAT WAS THE YEAR OF THE ELEPHANT?



HELLO EVERYONE. TODAY I WILL TALK ABOUT A FAMOUS EVENT CALLED
AAM AL-FEEL – WHICH MEANS "**THE YEAR OF THE ELEPHANT**" IN
ARABIC.

This event took place around **571 CE** – the same year the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was born. It was a very strange and powerful incident that people never forgot.

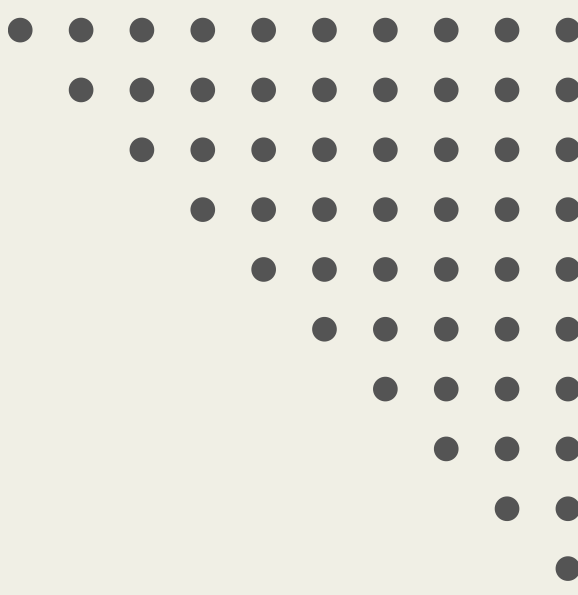


HISTORICAL BACKGROUND

At that time, **Yemen** was ruled by a Christian king named **Abraha**.
He built a beautiful, grand church.

He wanted all Arab pilgrims to come to his church instead of the
Kaaba in Mecca. But the Arabs loved the Kaaba and refused.
This made Abraha very angry.

So, he decided to march to Mecca and **destroy the Kaaba** forever.



STORY OF THE INCIDENT

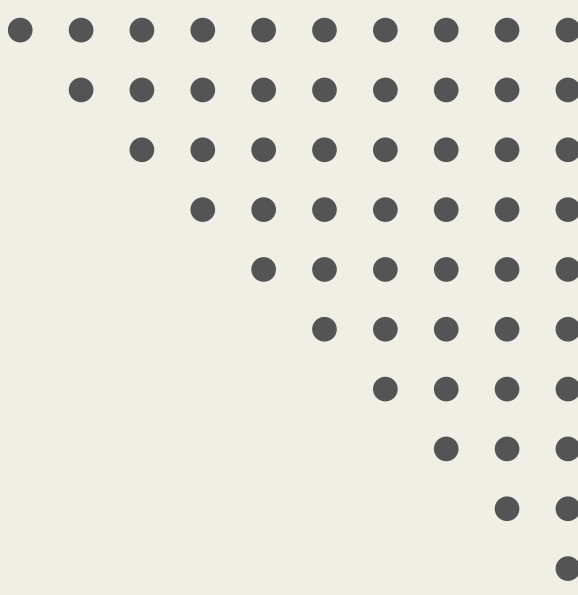
Abraha gathered a huge army. He also brought a **giant war elephant** – maybe named **Mahmud**. This elephant scared everyone.

They marched toward Mecca. The people of Mecca were weak and could not fight.
They ran to the mountains.

The leader of Mecca, **Abdul Muttalib**, said: "The Kaaba has its own Lord who will protect it."
When Abraha's army reached near Mecca, the elephant **refused to move forward** toward the Kaaba. It would only move sideways or back.

Then, **small birds (Ababil)** appeared in the sky. Each bird carried three small stones – one in its beak and two in its feet.

They dropped the stones on Abraha's army. The stones hit the soldiers, and they fell down like eaten crops.
Abraha himself was badly hurt and died later.



IMPACT OF THE INCIDENT

The impact was huge:

- **The Kaaba was saved.** The Arabs believed a divine power protected it.
- **Abraha's army was destroyed.** No one dared to attack Mecca for a long time.
- **The year became famous.** Arabs started calling it "The Year of the Elephant" to mark time.
- **It gave hope to the Arabs** that their faith was special.

SUMMARIZATION

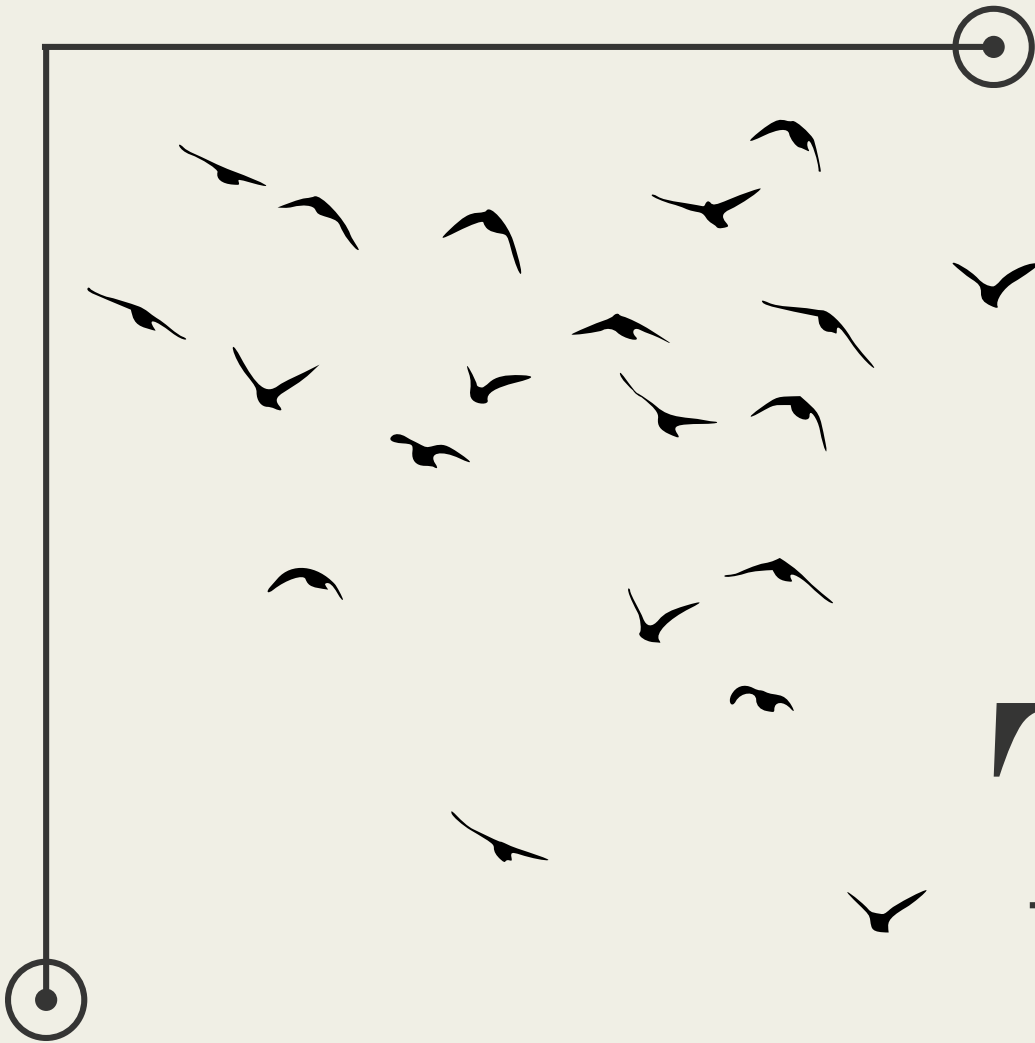
"Let me tell you about the Year of the Elephant. In 571 CE, a Christian king named Abraha came from Yemen with a huge army and a giant elephant. He wanted to destroy the Kaaba in Mecca because he wanted people to visit his church instead.

The people of Mecca were scared and ran to the hills. But the leader, Abdul Muttalib, said the Kaaba's Lord will protect it.

When the army reached near Mecca, the elephant stopped and refused to go forward. Then small birds appeared. Each bird threw small stones on the army. The stones hit the soldiers, and they all died. Abraha was badly hurt and died. This event saved the Kaaba, gave hope to the Arabs, and became so famous that they named the whole year after the elephant. It is also mentioned in the Quran. The lesson is simple: no matter how strong you are, you cannot defeat God."

REFERENCES

Source type	Name/refrence	Key innformation provided
Quran	Surah al Fil (105)	Birds (Ababil) destroyed the army with stones of clay.
Hadith	Ibn Ishaq / Ibn Hisham	Abraha built a church, the elephant (Mahmud) knelt and refused to enter Mecca, and `Abdul-Muttalib said "The House has a Lord who will protect it."



THANK YOU

By Duaa Jahangir

